

Part 1 Instructor Course Syllabus

1. Course Information

Course Number: Humanities 110.0009 – Technology and American Society

Meeting Time: Online

Semester: Summer 2026

Instructor: Dr. John Kaiser

Email Address: JJKaiser@waketech.edu

Campus Location: Online

Office Hours (Microsoft Teams):

- Mon.-Thurs. 11:30 am to Noon
- **Note:** Please email to schedule an apt. during office hours.

Preferred Method of Contact: email, JJKaiser@waketech.edu

- My policy is to respond to emails within 24-48 hours, or on the next business day. I do not respond to emails on weekends.

2. Instructor Policies

2.1 ATTENDANCE POLICY

For this synchronous online class, we will meet on Tuesday and Thursday from 10:00 am to 11:15 am. You are expected to login to the class and have both your microphone and camera on. You will be required to participate in the class discussions. Each meeting will be graded and 30% of your course grade is based on your attendance and participation in our online meetings. As points are awarded for our course meetings your portion of those 22 points will depend on you participating, being prepared when readings are assigned, keeping your camera turned, and engaging with other students when broken into small groups.

Note: If you decide to stop attending, you are ultimately responsible for notifying your instructor or submitting a withdrawal request to the registrar's office. Do not assume that your instructor will automatically submit the withdrawal form to the registrar's office. Students who fail to submit a withdrawal form are in danger of receiving an F for the class.

Wake Tech Attendance Policy Regarding Withdrawal

“Wake Tech expects students to attend at least 90% of all scheduled class meetings. If a student's consecutive absences from class exceed 10% of the total instructional time, the student has not communicated with the instructor and the student is currently not passing the class, then the faculty member should withdraw the student from the class.”

2.2 Grades & Assignments

Evaluations

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Attendance – 300 points (~22 points per class meeting)

Tech Presentation – 150 points (I will select 5 students each week to present)

Quizzes – 150 points (6 quizzes as 25 points each)

Final Exam – 100 points

Discussion Boards – 300 points (3 discussion boards at 100 points each)

Ten Point Grading Scale:

A = 90-100%

B = 80-89%

C = 70-79%

D = 60-69%

F = 59% and Below

Grading Assignments

Students should expect to receive grades for submitted assignments within two weeks.

2.3 Discussion Boards and Tech Presentations

You will complete a discussion board in weeks 2, 4, and 6.

I will post a presentation schedule in Blackboard. Five (5) students will give presentations during our Thursday Course meetings each week. I will assign an invention to each student one week before the presentation.

Each presentation will be 10 minutes in length (minimum) and no longer than 12 minutes. The presentations will focus on an invention on the list provided in Blackboard and correspond to that week's assigned readings. You will be graded on using quality sources (museums, academic websites, etc., NOT encyclopedias), putting the invention within its historical context (the historical forces that played a role in its creation AND how it affected society), discussing the inventor (if one is known) and, of course, a bit about how it works/is made.

2.4 Late Work & Academic Honor Code

Journals/discussions can be submitted late but with a 25% grade penalty up until 7/6. Quizzes will not be accepted late. No distinction is made between excused and unexcused absences. However, I do provide two extra credit opportunities at the end of the semester.

You are expected to read and abide by the Wake Technical Community College Academic Integrity Policy and Student Code of Conduct.

Every assignment that you turn in should bear the following

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statement, accompanied by your signature: "I have neither given nor received unauthorized aid on this assignment." For online assignments, clicking "Submit" will constitute signature of the honor statement. Your signature indicates not only your avowal of the truth of the statement, but also that you have familiarized yourself with the Wake Technical Community College Academic Integrity Policy. **Please note that unauthorized use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) constitutes a violation of the Academic Integrity Policy.**

3. Important Information and Dates

Course Entry Census Date: 5/20/2026

- Students who have not taken the Course Entry Quiz by 11:59 PM on May 20 will not be allowed into the class.

First Day of Class: 5/18/26

Last Day to Withdraw with a W (withdrawal): 7/01/2025

Last Day of Class: 7/09/2025

4. Course Outline

NOTE: The instructor reserves the right to make changes in course content or course schedule, as necessary.

Week 1 – Introduction to the Course

- Beginnings of Technology and Man (reading in assigned .pdf document)

Week 2 – "The Emergency of Technology"

- Mesopotamian and Egyptian Technology (reading in assigned .pdf document)
- The Classical Civilizations (reading in assigned .pdf document)
- Technology in the Middle Ages. (reading in assigned .pdf document)

Week 3 – "The Emergency of Technology" and Early Modern Tech

- Early Modern, Technology to 1600 (reading in assigned .pdf document)
- Ch. 1: The Land, The Natives, and the Settlers (A Social History Textbook)
- Ch. 2: Agriculture and Craft Work in the Colonies (A Social History Textbook)

Week 4 – Transportation & Technological Systems

- Ch. 4: Transportation Revolutions (A Social History Textbook)
- Ch. 5: Technological Systems and Industrial Society (A Social History Textbook)

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Week 5 – Everyday Labor & Inventors and Entrepreneurs

- Ch. 6: Everyday Labor in the Mechanical Age (A Social History Textbook)
- Ch. 7: Inventors, Entrepreneurs, Engineers, and Industrialization (A Social History Textbook)

Week 6 – Planes, Trains, and Automobiles

- Ch. 8: Automobiles and Automobility (A Social History Textbook)
- Ch. 9: Taxpayers, Generals, and Aerospace (A Social History Textbook)

Week 7 – Electronic Communication and Social Control

- Ch. 10: Electronic Communication and Social Control (A Social History Textbook)

Week 8 – Final Exam